

KENYA JUNIOR SCHOOL EDUCATION ASSESSMENT

GRADE 9 2025



ENGLISH PAPER 2

Time: 1 hour 30 minutes

Learner's Details

Name:

Grade:

School:

Assessment Number:

Signature: Date:

Instructions to Learners

- Write your name, school name, and assessment number in the spaces provided.
- This paper consists of **five tasks**.
- Ensure all pages are printed and no question is missing.
- Answer **all questions** in the spaces provided.
- Sign at the end of the assessment.

Score Grid

Section	Maximum Score	Learner's Score	Performance Level
Task 1	15		
Task 2	10		
Task 3	5		
Task 4	10		
Task 5	10		
Total	50		

SECTION A: COMPOSITION (15 Marks)

Task 1: Composition

Write your composition in the spaces provided. Begin with:

“The sun began to set, casting a golden glow over the horizon. The ceremony was about to start. I felt excited, knowing this moment would change everything ...”

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dotted lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a guide for handwriting or typing. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

Handwriting practice area with 20 sets of horizontal dotted lines.

SECTION B: LITERARY ANALYSIS (35 Marks)

Task 2: Oral Literature (10 Marks)

Read the narrative below and answer the questions.

The Clever Tortoise and the Foolish Monkey

Long ago, Tortoise and Monkey were neighbours. Tortoise was slow but wise while Monkey was quick and playful. One dry season, food became scarce. Tortoise suggested they plant sweet potatoes together. Monkey agreed, but when it was time to dig, Monkey climbed trees instead. Tortoise did all the hard work.

When the potatoes were ready, Monkey wanted to eat the leaves, thinking they were the best part. Tortoise happily let him have them and kept the tubers for himself. Monkey soon realised his mistake, but Tortoise reminded him that patience and hard work always pay off.

Questions:

- a) Identify the **opening and closing formulae** in this story. (2 marks)
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.....
- b) State **two ways** you would make this story more interesting if you were telling it to your friends. (2 marks)
.....
.....
- c) What feature in the story shows that Tortoise is wise? (2 marks)
.....
.....
- d) What was Monkey’s mistake according to this narrative? (2 marks)
.....
.....
- e) What lesson do we learn from this story? (2 marks)
.....
.....

Task 3: Poetry (5 Marks)

Morning Reflections

*In the quiet of the morning,
I watch the world awake.
Birds sing their stories,
The wind whispers through the trees.
I wonder what the day will bring,
As sunlight dances on the leaves.*

*A golden hush fills the meadow,
Where dew still clings to blades of grass.
Clouds drift like thoughts unspoken,
Moments too tender to pass.
Hope stretches in every shadow,
As time begins to gently amass.*

*A breeze stirs dreams I'd left behind,
Soft footsteps of a brand-new start.
The world feels wide with promise,
Peace echoing in my heart.
In the stillness, I find my centre,
Ready now to play my part.*

Questions:

a) Identify the **point of view** used in this poem. What is its effect on how the poem’s message is delivered? (2 marks)

.....

.....

b) Who is the **persona** in this poem? (1 mark)

.....

.....

c) Name **two other participants** mentioned or implied in the poem. (2 marks)

.....

.....

Task 4: Play (10 Marks)

Read the excerpt below and answer the questions.

Act Two, Scene One

(The classroom is arranged for a debate. At the front, the teacher stands ready to moderate. Three learners, Amina, Brian, and Lila, prepare their arguments. The classmates wait eagerly.)

TEACHER: Welcome everyone. Today we debate on: *“Technology is more helpful than harmful.”* Amina, you may begin.

AMINA: Thank you, Teacher. Technology connects us and makes learning easier.

BRIAN: But it can also distract us and make us less active.

LILA: I believe technology is helpful if we use it wisely.

TEACHER: Excellent points. Let’s hear from the audience.

JAMES: (From the audience) I agree with Amina. I use online videos to understand Maths better.

SARAH: (From the audience) But sometimes I spend hours on games and forget to do my homework.

TEACHER: That’s honest, Sarah. So, it seems technology is a tool; it depends on how we use it.

AMINA: Exactly! We need to learn how to balance our screen time.

BRIAN: Maybe schools should teach us how to use technology responsibly.

LILA: Yes, and parents can also guide us at home.

TEACHER: Wonderful ideas! Today’s debate reminds us that technology is powerful, but with power comes responsibility.

Questions:

a) List **two characters** in the play and state their roles. (2 marks)

.....

.....

- b) Analyse the **relationship between Amina and Brian** based on their interaction. (2 marks)
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-
- c) Identify one **feature of style** used in the play and give an example. (2 marks)
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- d) Suggest one **prop** and one **costume** that could be used to create mood and atmosphere in this scene. (4 marks)
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Task 5: Novella (10 Marks)

Read the passage below and answer the questions.

The Flooded Garden

The rain poured all night. In the morning, Mama Wanjia found her garden flooded. Her son, Kevin, offered to help her save the vegetables. Together, they dug small channels to drain the water. As they worked, Kevin realised how much effort went into growing food. By afternoon, the garden was safe and they were both tired but happy.

Later that evening, as they sat on the porch sipping warm tea, Kevin looked out at the garden and said, *“I never knew farming was this hard, Mama. I’ll never waste food again.”*

Mama Wanja smiled and gently placed her hand on his shoulder. *“When we work with our hands,”* she said, *“we learn to appreciate every harvest.”* The sky had cleared and a soft breeze carried the scent of wet soil and fresh leaves.

Questions:

a) What is the **setting** of the story? (2 marks)

.....

.....

b) Describe **two character traits of Kevin**, giving examples from the story. (4 marks)

.....

.....

c) Name the **other character** in the story and show their relationship with Kevin. (2 marks)

.....

.....

d) What is the **purpose of the dialogue** in this story? (2 marks)

.....

.....

SECTION A: COMPOSITION (15 Marks)

Task 1: Composition

- Candidates must write a **coherent, imaginative composition** beginning with the given sentence.
- Marking is based on **content, creativity, relevance, grammar, and organization**.

Marking Guide (15 marks):

- **Content & Creativity (6 marks)** – originality, development of ideas, engaging storyline.
- **Relevance (3 marks)** – must follow the opening line and remain relevant to the theme.
- **Language Use (4 marks)** – correct grammar, spelling, vocabulary, sentence variety.
- **Organization (2 marks)** – logical flow, paragraphing, introduction-body-conclusion.

Sample Good Ending:

- The character experiences a life-changing event (e.g., initiation, graduation, cultural ceremony, achievement).
- The story should reflect growth, excitement, or change.

Sample Composition

Title: A New Beginning

The sun began to set, casting a golden glow over the horizon. The ceremony was about to start. I felt excited, knowing this moment would change everything.

People gathered in the village square, dressed in colourful attire. Drums beat rhythmically, and the air was filled with laughter and anticipation. This was the day I was being recognized for completing my journey of initiation into adulthood. My heart raced as elders walked in slowly, their faces glowing with pride.

As the ceremony began, I remembered the challenges I had faced. Days of training, moments of fear, and nights of doubt all led to this one day. I had learned the importance of patience, courage, and responsibility.

When my name was called, I stepped forward, trembling yet determined. The chief placed a beaded necklace around my neck. The crowd cheered, and I saw my parents smiling with joy. At that moment, I knew life would never be the same again.

The sun disappeared beyond the hills, but a new light shone in my heart. I was no longer a child; I had taken my first step into adulthood.

SECTION B: LITERARY ANALYSIS (35 Marks)

Task 2: Oral Literature (10 Marks)

The Clever Tortoise and the Foolish Monkey

a) Opening and Closing Formulae (2 marks)

- Possible opening: *“Long ago…”* (1 mark)
- Possible closing: *“…patience and hard work always pay off.”* (1 mark)

b) Ways to make story interesting (2 marks)

- Use gestures, facial expressions, or mimicry (1 mark).
- Vary tone/voice, song, or audience participation (1 mark).

c) Feature showing Tortoise is wise (2 marks)

- He allows Monkey to take leaves while keeping tubers (1 mark).
- He knows tubers are more valuable (1 mark).

d) Monkey’s mistake (2 marks)

- He thought potato leaves were the best part (1 mark).
- He avoided hard work and wanted to enjoy benefits (1 mark).

e) Lesson learnt (2 marks)

- Patience and hard work are rewarded (1 mark).
- Laziness and greed lead to loss/regret (1 mark).

Task 3: Poetry (5 Marks)

Morning Reflections

a) **Point of view** (2 marks)

- First person point of view (1 mark).
- Effect: Makes the poem personal and reflective, allowing the reader to share persona's inner thoughts (1 mark).

b) **Persona** (1 mark)

- A reflective individual/narrator observing nature and life.

c) **Two participants implied in the poem** (2 marks)

- Birds (1 mark).
 - The wind (1 mark).
- Other acceptable: clouds, meadow, grass, sunlight.*

Task 4: Play (10 Marks)

a) **Two characters and their roles** (2 marks)

- Amina – argues technology is helpful (1 mark).
- Brian – argues technology can be harmful (1 mark).

b) **Relationship between Amina and Brian** (2 marks)

- They are **debate opponents** but respectful of each other's views (2 marks).

c) **Feature of style and example** (2 marks)

- Dialogue (1 mark) – e.g., exchange between Teacher and learners (1 mark).
- Other possible: stage directions (e.g., "James: (From the audience)").*

d) **Prop and costume** (4 marks)

- Prop: Debate placards, books, or microphone (2 marks).
- Costume: School uniform to show learners (2 marks).

Task 5: Novella (10 Marks)

The Flooded Garden

a) **Setting** (2 marks)

- Rural/farm setting in the garden and home (2 marks).

b) **Kevin's character traits** (4 marks)

- Helpful – he assists his mother (1 mark + example).
 - Hardworking – digs channels until garden is safe (1 mark + example).
 - Appreciative/reflective – vows never to waste food again (1 mark + example).
- (Award 2 marks per trait with illustration, any 2 traits = 4 marks.)*

c) **Other character and relationship** (2 marks)

- Mama Wanja (1 mark).
- She is Kevin's mother (1 mark).

d) **Purpose of dialogue** (2 marks)

- Reveals lessons about farming and food (1 mark).
- Shows emotional bond and values (1 mark).

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